A POCKET HOME PROJECT · G+1 FAMILY HOME

Illam.

A family of four, two board years, one small plot.

PLOT
1,050 sq.ft

BUILT-UP
1,800 sq.ft

TYPOLOGY
G+1



Illam simply means *home.*

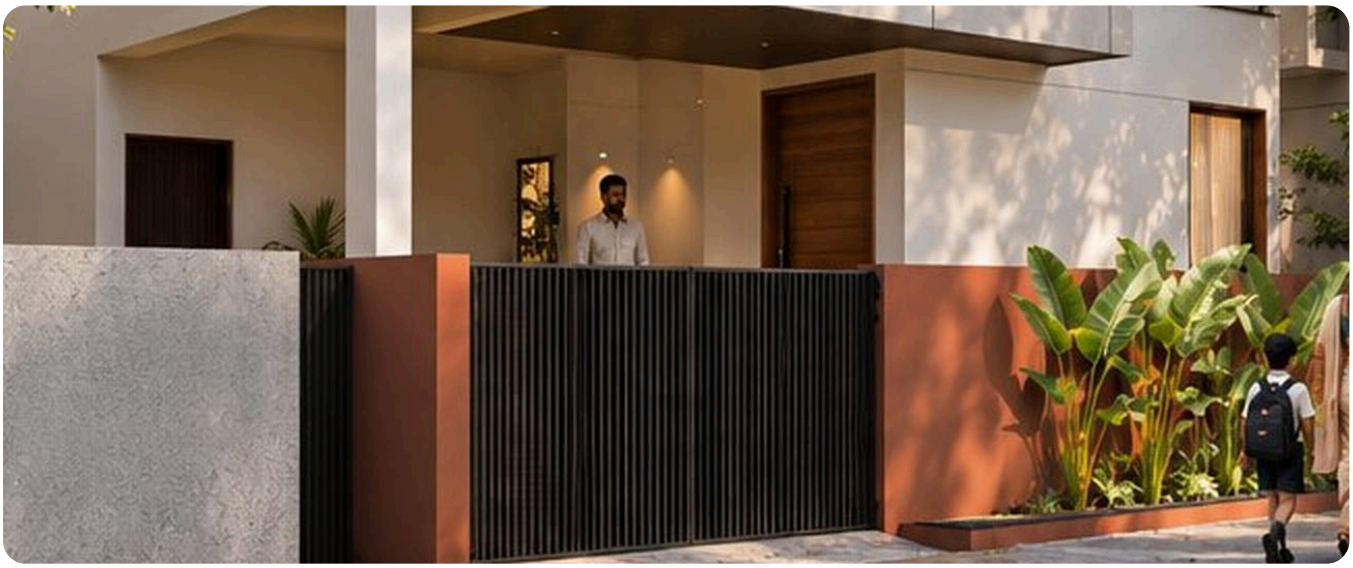
The Tamil word is plain, and so was the idea. **A couple, a son in 12th Standard, a daughter in 10th.** Not a showpiece. A house that works for the four of them, on a plot of 1,050 sq.ft.

A door to *close.*

Board years need quiet. Each child gets a room upstairs, away from the kitchen and the television, with a bath of its own.

A table to *come back to.*

Downstairs stays open. Kitchen, dining and living run together, so the family still meets at the end of a long study day.



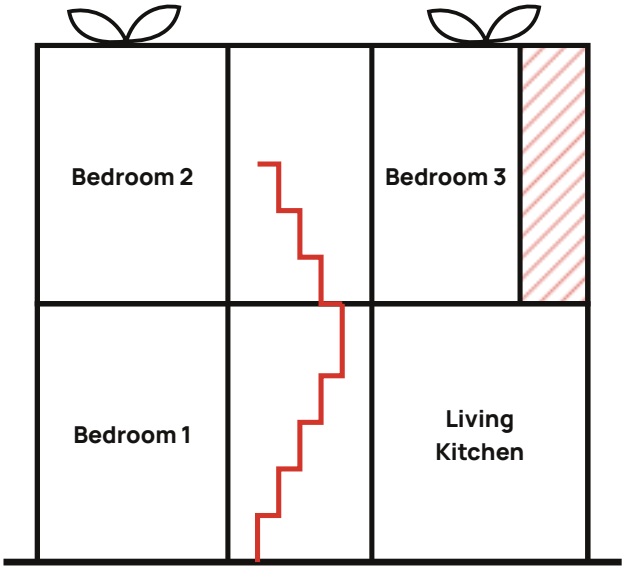
01 THE STREET EDGE: SLATTED GATE, TERRACOTTA WALL, PLANTER

AT A GLANCE

PLOT	BUILT-UP	TYPOLOGY	BEDROOMS
1,050 sq.ft	1,800 sq.ft	G+1	3

Two floors, *two* rhythms.

The stair sits in the middle of the plan and does the sorting. **Below it, the shared day. Above it, the private one.**



01

First floor, the study floor

A room each for the son and daughter, each with an attached toilet and wardrobes. Between them, a hall that opens onto the family deck for a break from the books.

2 BEDROOMS · 2 TOILETS · 3 DECKS

00

Ground floor, the shared floor

Car park, porch, living, dining and kitchen, plus the parents' bedroom. No stairs needed for daily life.

1 BEDROOM · 2 TOILETS · CAR PARK

A DAY AT ILLAM

- **Morning**
  Everyone meets in the kitchen and at the table before the day splits up.
- **After school**
  Up the stairs and into a quiet room, with the deck for breaks.
- **Late night**
  The house below goes dark, while study lamps stay on upstairs and disturb nobody.

The home outlasts the *exam*.

Board years end. College begins. When the children move on, the parents already have everything they need on one level, and the rooms upstairs are ready whenever the children come home.

Why it matters on 1,050 sq.ft

Noise travels fast in a small house. A floor between the living room and the study desks is a planning decision, not an added expense.

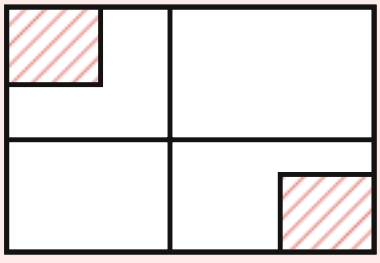
Eight things every small plot *needs.*

The same eight principles guide every Pocket Home. Here is how each one plays out at Illam.

- **Light**
  Windows on every side of the house. The stair is glazed at both ends, so the centre of the plan never goes dark.
- **Wind**
  Openings on opposite sides of the house let air move through it instead of sitting in it.
- **Optimize**
  One central hall serves every room. Almost no floor is spent on corridor.
- **Storage**
  A wardrobe wall downstairs, a dressing passage and wardrobes upstairs, a room under the stair.
- **Layout**
  Shared life below, study and sleep above. The parents never need the stairs for daily life.
- **Energy**
  The upper floor overhangs the entrance and shades it. Good daylight means fewer lights on before evening.
- **Plant**
  Planters line both side yards downstairs and all three decks upstairs. Green is in view from every level.
- **Maintenance**
  Plain plastered walls and a paved yard for washing and drying. Simple surfaces, easy to keep clean.

Small plots deserve *better.*

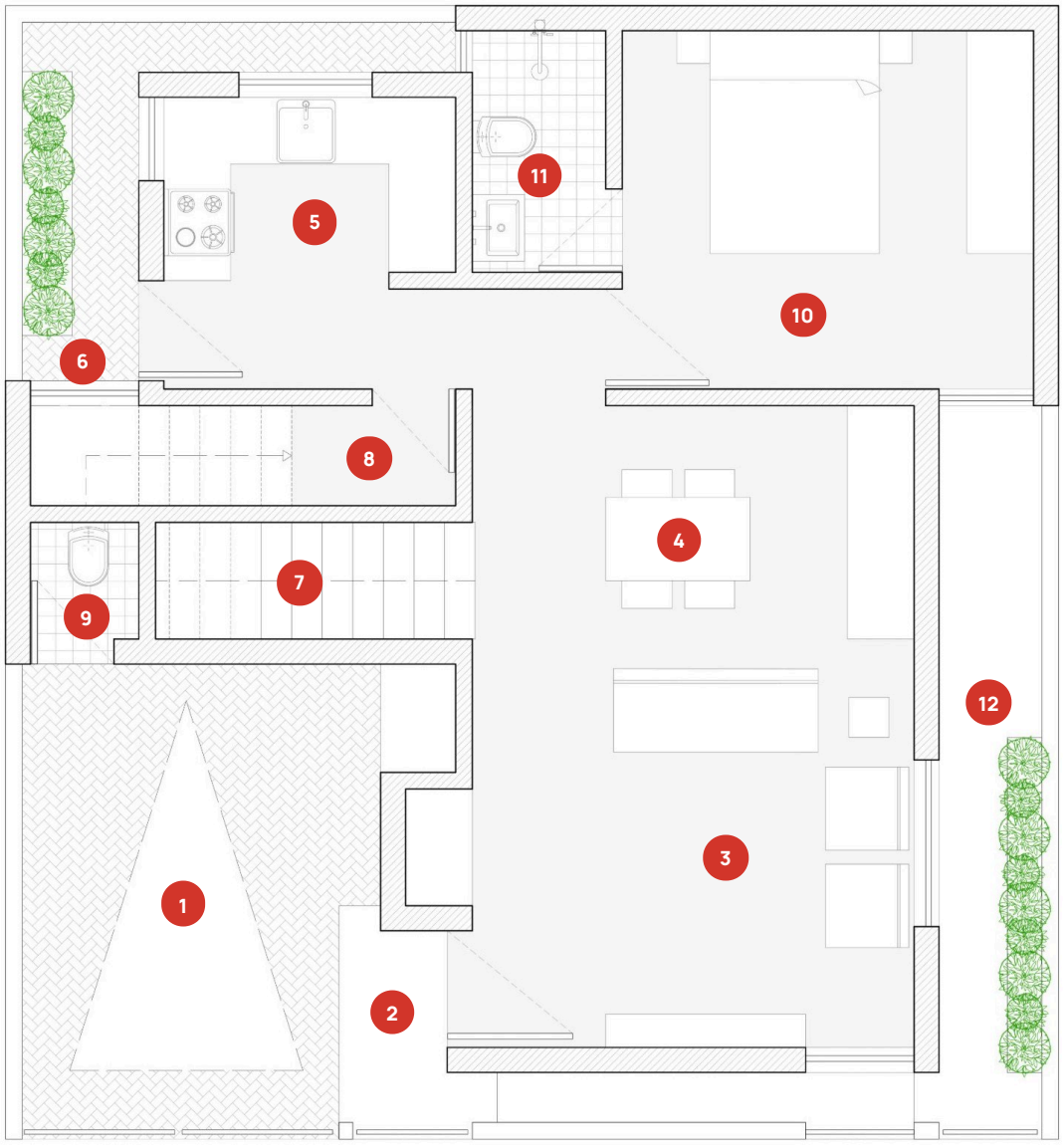
A stock plan leaves dark corners and dead passages. A plan drawn for one plot and one family puts every corner to work.



The *shared* floor.

From the car park to the kitchen, one continuous family space.

1 bedroom
+ LIVING, DINING, KITCHEN



1 Car park
Paved, gated, off the street

2 Entry porch
Covered, door to the side

3 Living
Sofa, TV wall, side-garden window

4 Dining
Table for four, tall jali-door unit

5 Kitchen
U-shaped counter, window over the sink

6 Service yard
Washing and drying, door from the hall

7 Stair
Doglegs up from the central hall

8 Under-stair room
Door from the hall

9 Common toilet
Entered from outside, by the car park

10 Bedroom 1
Parents' room, full wardrobe wall

11 Attached toilet
Inside Bedroom 1, with a window

12 Side garden
Planter strip outside the living room

A hall, not a corridor

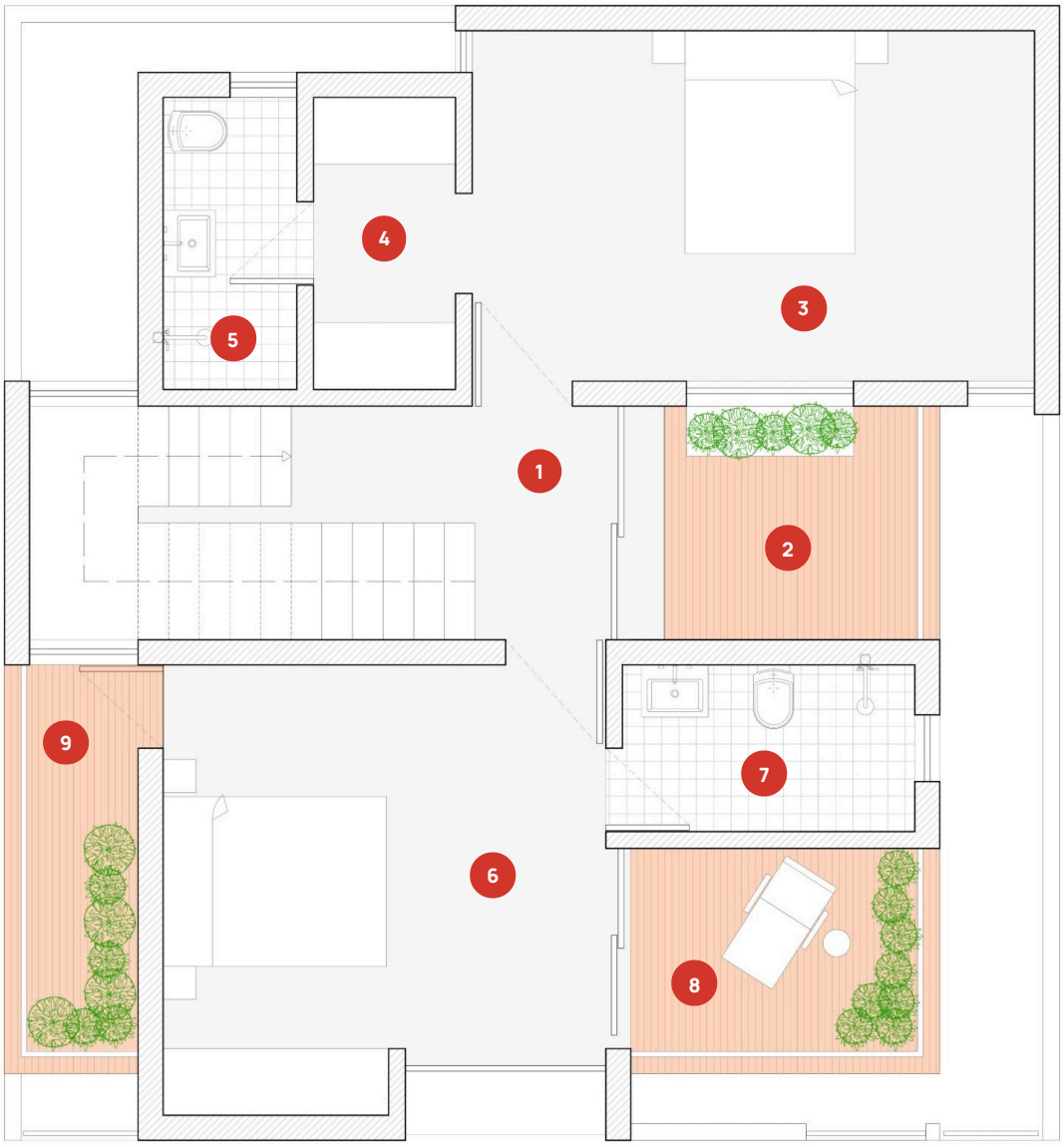
Kitchen, parents' bedroom, stair and living all open off one central hall. It stays lit and airy, and nobody walks through a room to reach another.

OPEN PLAN · SIDE GARDEN

The *study* floor.

Two rooms, two baths, and three decks to step out onto.

2 bedrooms
+ 3 PLANTED DECKS



1 **Stair hall**
Glazed at both ends of the stair

2 **Family deck**
Off the hall, sliding doors, planter

3 **Bedroom 2**
Corner room, window onto the planter

4 **Dressing passage**
Wardrobes either side

5 **Attached toilet**
For Bedroom 2

6 **Bedroom 3**
Own wardrobe, opens to two decks

7 **Attached toilet**
For Bedroom 3

8 **Sun deck**
Off Bedroom 3, room for a lounger

9 **Side deck**
Off Bedroom 3, L-shaped planter

Fresh air between chapters

Every room upstairs is a few steps from outdoors. On a 1,050 sq.ft plot, the decks are the garden, and the best place to clear your head between subjects.

3 DECKS · PLANTERS



One room for the *whole* family.

Sofa and dining table share one long room, so the end of a study day has somewhere to land.



01 DINING AND THE TALL UNIT BESIDE IT



02 MAIN DOOR, CONSOLE AND STAIR

- **Jali-door unit**
  A cut pattern on tall white doors, with open shelves on either side.
- **Slatted TV wall**
  Warm vertical slats give the far end of the room its character.



A kitchen built for *every day.*

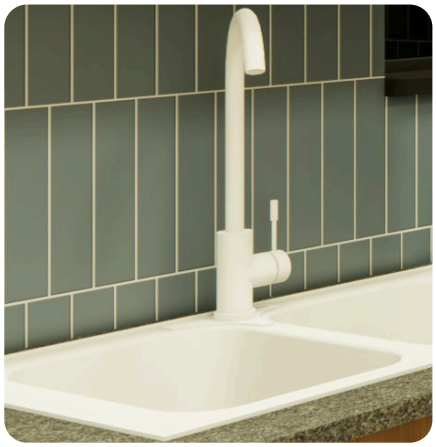
A U-shaped counter keeps everything a turn away, with storage above and below it.



01 GLASS-FRONT DISH RACKS



02 OPEN SHELVES



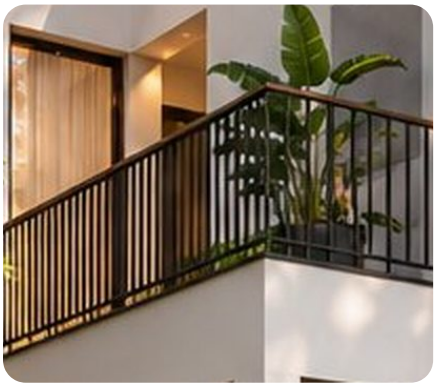
03 STACKED TILE BACKSPLASH

- **Storage to the top**
  Wood-finish cabinets run high, so little wall goes unused.
- **Easy to wipe down**
  Tiled walls behind the counter and a dark speckled worktop.

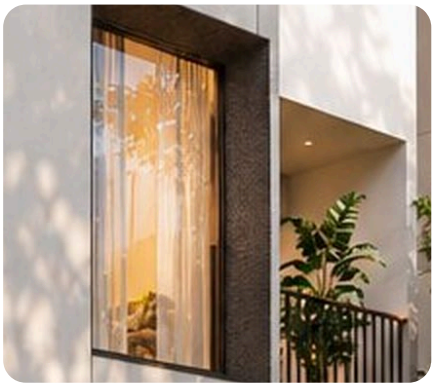


THE FACADE

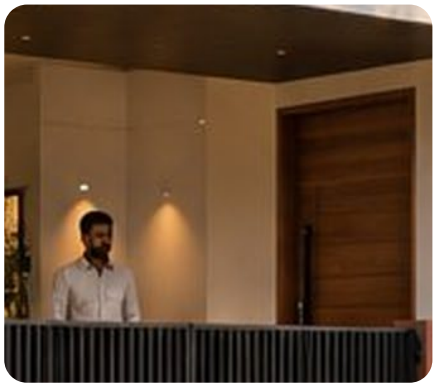
Quiet from the *street.*



01 UPPER BALCONY



02 FRAMED WINDOW



03 ENTRANCE

- **White volumes** — Simple stacked forms.
- **Framed window** — A deep dark surround.
- **Balconies** — Slim railings, planters.
- **Street wall** — Terracotta, black slats.

We don't design.
We solve.

Illam began with a family's next few years and a 1,050 sq.ft plot. Tell us about yours.

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